

# Week 5 Lit Example Reader

## JULIUS CAESAR: BRUTUS, ANTONY, AND FORMAL SHAPE

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**Purpose:** This reader gives Julius Caesar passages for applying Week 5's logic habit: identify mood, test formal validity, and separate a clean form from a proved premise.

**What to watch for:** Brutus and Antony both speak about honor, ambition, freedom, and death. The emotional language matters, but Week 5 asks first whether the form of the argument can carry the conclusion if the premises are granted.

### Before the Passages: The Week 5 Logic Tool

A categorical syllogism has three claims. Its **mood** names the form of the major premise, minor premise, and conclusion: A, E, I, or O. A beginner valid form is AAA in the first figure: All M are P; All S are M; therefore All S are P. Week 5's question is not yet whether every premise is true. First ask: *if the premises were true, would the conclusion have to follow?*

### Passage 1: Act 3, Scene 2 — Brutus Explains the Killing

**Context:** Brutus has joined the assassination of Caesar. He now faces the Roman citizens and tries to justify what the conspirators have done.

**Brutus.** Romans, countrymen, and lovers! hear me for my cause,  
and be silent, that you may hear: believe me for mine honour,  
and have respect to mine honour, that you may believe.  
If then that friend demand why Brutus rose against Caesar,  
this is my answer:—Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I  
loved Rome more. Had you rather Caesar were living and die all  
slaves, than that Caesar were dead, to live all free men? As  
Caesar loved me, I weep for him; as he was fortunate, I rejoice  
at it; as he was valiant, I honour him: but, as he was ambitious,  
I slew him. There is tears for his love; joy for his fortune;  
honour for his valour; and death for his ambition.  
Who is here so base that would be a bondman? If any, speak;  
for him have I offended. Who is here so rude that would not be  
a Roman? If any, speak; for him have I offended.

### Reader Notes

Here is your most assisted example. One possible formal map is: All men whose ambition would enslave Rome deserve death for Rome's freedom; Caesar was a man whose ambition would enslave Rome; therefore Caesar deserved death for Rome's freedom. That map has an AAA shape: All M are P; All S are M; therefore All S are P. The form is strong if the terms are held steady.

**Reading task:** Underline Brutus's conclusion. Circle the word *ambitious*. Mark the sentence that makes the crowd choose between slavery and freedom.

## Passage 2: Act 3, Scene 2 — Antony Presses the Middle Term

**Context:** Antony speaks after Brutus. He does not begin by diagramming a syllogism. Instead, he repeats Brutus's key term and gives evidence that pressures it.

**Antony.** The noble Brutus  
Hath told you Caesar was ambitious:  
If it were so, it was a grievous fault,  
And grievously hath Caesar answer'd it.  
Here, under leave of Brutus and the rest—  
For Brutus is an honourable man;  
So are they all, all honourable men—  
Come I to speak in Caesar's funeral.  
He was my friend, faithful and just to me:  
But Brutus says he was ambitious;  
And Brutus is an honourable man.  
He hath brought many captives home to Rome  
Whose ransoms did the general coffers fill:  
Did this in Caesar seem ambitious?  
When that the poor have cried, Caesar hath wept:  
Ambition should be made of sterner stuff:  
Yet Brutus says he was ambitious;  
And Brutus is an honourable man.  
You all did see that on the Lupercal  
I thrice presented him a kingly crown,  
Which he did thrice refuse: was this ambition?  
Yet Brutus says he was ambitious.

### Reader Notes

Antony may not give a cleaner syllogism than Brutus. He gives counter-evidence. Watch whether his reasoning proves a universal negative, proves a weaker particular claim, or simply makes Brutus's minor premise doubtful. Decide how much his evidence can formally support.

**Reading task:** Number Antony's three pieces of evidence. Beside each, write whether it attacks the term *ambitious*, the conclusion that Caesar deserved death, or both.

## How to Use These Passages on the Worksheet

The worksheet asks you to apply the form test. Do not skip straight to whether you like Brutus or Antony. First identify the shape. Then decide what the form proves and what still depends on evidence.